

People Pay \$300+ For This Book. Here's Why

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Oct 09, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/shorts/MoFXM563K0k> Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

Most online fitness coaches fail to get clients because they pitch too early. Eugene Schwartz's *Breakthrough Advertising* outlines five buyer awareness levels that show exactly how and when to market to anyone.

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The Core Mistake Most Online Coaches Make 0:22

- The only thing most people say online is "Hey, DM me for coaching"
 - This fails because it assumes the prospect is already ready to buy
 - Brandon compares it to "trying to smash as soon as you meet somebody" — it'll occasionally work, but it is not a reliable strategy
- Pitching too early ignores where the buyer actually is in their decision journey

The Book and Why It Matters 0:00

- The book is **Breakthrough Advertising** by **Eugene Schwartz**
 - Copies sell for over **\$300** on the secondary market
 - Considered "the foundation of modern marketing"
- Brandon credits its principles with helping him make **over \$20 million online**
- He has also used the framework to help **thousands of people** grow successful online fitness businesses
- The book's central insight: every buyer sits at one of **five awareness levels**, and your marketing must match the level they're actually at

Level 1: Unaware 0:46

- The buyer does **not even realize they have a problem**
 - Pitching a solution here will confuse them — "they won't know what the f*** you're talking about"
- Marketing strategy: describe **symptoms** they might personally recognize, not the problem itself
 - Example (fat loss coaching): target someone who doesn't think they're out of shape even at **15% body fat**
 - Hook approach: "You don't have as much energy as you used to" or "You're getting tired more often"
 - These symptoms resonate before the person has framed their situation as a problem

2 Level 2: Problem Aware [1:08](#)

- The buyer knows they have a problem but **has no idea how to fix it**
- Marketing strategy:
 - Acknowledge and validate their struggle so they feel understood
 - Introduce a path forward — give them direction without a full pitch yet
- Example hook: *"Hey, if you're struggling to lose fat, here are some things you can do every day to eat less without feeling hungry."*
 - Leads with empathy, then offers actionable hope

3 Level 3: Solution Aware [1:31](#)

- The buyer knows **a solution exists** but doesn't know about *your* specific solution
- Marketing strategy: explain your approach and **differentiate** it from everything else available
 - This is where your unique mechanism or method gets introduced
- Example hook: *"Hey, you don't have to give up your favorite foods in order to lose weight."*
 - Follow-up: "I give my clients custom workout plans and custom diet plans that incorporate their favorite foods, so it doesn't feel like they're missing out."
 - The angle directly counters the most common objection at this level

4 Level 4: Product Aware [1:54](#)

- The buyer knows about your product or service but is **not yet convinced it's right for them**
- Marketing strategy: provide **proof** — remove doubt with social evidence
 - Tactic: bombard them with testimonials
 - Brandon's rule: *"The perfect amount of testimonials is infinite."*
 - There is no ceiling — more proof always helps at this stage

5 Level 5: Most Aware [2:18](#)

- The buyer **knows your offer and wants it** — they just need details and a reason to act now
- Marketing strategy: make a **clear, direct offer**

- Tell them exactly what will happen inside the program
- State what it costs
- Explain how they can join
- No need for education, empathy, or differentiation at this stage — just clarity and a call to action

The biggest insight: stop leading with "DM me for coaching." Match your message to where the buyer actually is — unaware, curious, comparing, skeptical, or ready — and you'll convert far more people at every stage.